

GREGORY CHEN

Pianist based in New York and Boston, specializing in early twentieth-century jazz styles.

gregorychen3@proton.me · www.gregory-chen.com

PERFORMING EXPERIENCE

Selected Venues

New York, NY Avery Fisher Hall at Lincoln Center · Cellar Dog · Children's Museum of Manhattan · Columbia Club · Dizzy's Club Coca Cola · Gramercy Theatre · Harvard Club · Mezzrow · Puppets Jazz Bar · Riverside Church · Smalls Jazz Club · Smoke Jazz Club · Somethin' Jazz Club · Symphony Space · The Garage · Westchester Presbyterian Jazz Society · World Trade Center · Yale Club

National American Jazz Museum, Kansas City, MO · Capital Club, San Jose, CA · Center for Performing Arts, San Jose, CA · Hillside Club, Berkeley, CA · Jazz at the Bistro, St. Louis, MO · Kennedy Center, Washington, D.C. · Manchester Craftsmen's Guild, Pittsburgh, PA · Mike Tomaro Jazz Camp, Pittsburgh, PA · Monterey Jazz Festival, Monterey, CA · San Jose Jazz Festival, San Jose, CA · Tech Museum, San Jose, CA · The Improv, San Jose, CA · The Jazz Showcase, Chicago, IL · The Jazzschool, Berkeley, CA · WASBE Convention, Cincinnati, OH · Yoshi's Jazz Club, Oakland, CA · Yoshi's Jazz Club, San Francisco, CA

Selected Collaborations

Artists: Aaron Johnson · Alex Hoffman · Anton Schwartz · Barry Harris · Bobby Watson · Candido Camero · Dan Gabel · Dean Torrey · Emanuele Basentini · Jon Gordon · Lee Konitz · Scott Lowrie · Steve Wilson · Tim Lin · Wycliffe Gordon · Wynton Marsalis

Ensembles: Jazz Band of America · MSM Afro-Cuban Jazz Orchestra · Next Generation Jazz Orchestra · Reno Jazz Festival All Stars · San Jose Jazz Society All Stars

DISCOGRAPHY

- *Serenade in Blue* — Aaron Johnson & Gregory Chen (Boptimist Records, 2026)
- *Sessions, Vol. 1* — Gregory Chen, Ben Zweig, Kevin Hsieh (Boptimist Records, 2024)

RECORD LABEL

Co-Founder — Boptimist Records

2026 – Present · New York, NY · boptimistrecords.com

Independent jazz label dedicated to the living jazz tradition, producing handmade records from the New York scene. Catalog includes releases by Pat Brennan Quintet, Ilya Lushtak, and Sacha Perry, alongside the co-founders' own projects.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Private Instructor — Music Performance, Theory, and Appreciation

2006 – Present

Student successes: Berkeley Jazzschool Advanced High School Jazz Workshop · Berklee College of Music · NYU · San Jose Youth Jazz Orchestra · SFJAZZ Youth All-Stars · The New School for Jazz and Contemporary Music · University of North Texas

Piano Instructor — NYC Public Schools / Afro Latin Jazz Alliance

Nov. 2011 – Nov. 2012 · New York, NY After-school piano instruction at Bronx Studio School for Writers and Artists (PS 268) and the Business of Sports School (PS 393), developing students' technical facility, music appreciation, and teamwork.

Music Instructor — San Jose Jazz Society

Summers 2010, 2011 · San Jose, CA Beginning piano, music theory, jazz improvisation, and small-group ensemble instruction for middle and high school students, culminating in a community concert.

EDUCATION

Manhattan School of Music

B.M. in Jazz Piano Performance · 2013 · New York, NY

Columbia University

B.A. in Computer Science · 2017 · New York, NY